



REAL POWER FOR THE PEOPLE OF WALES

VOTE

WELSH COMMUNIST PARTY
SENEDD ELECTIONS

6 MAY 2021

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REAL POWER FOR THE PEOPLE OF WALES!

Manifesto of the Welsh Communist Party Senedd elections 6 May 2021

EMERGING FROM COVID

The Welsh Communist Party understands that people are feeling battered and bruised by the Covid-19 crisis. Many are bereaved. It's a tough time – and tougher for some than for others.

We also understand that important lessons have been learned. People want more control over their lives and their communities. In particular, we want our key and front-line workers to be rewarded with decent pay and conditions.

The Covid crisis has shown how much we need real power in the hands of the people of Wales.

Under-investment in NHS, elderly social care, manufacturing and civil emergency planning meant we were not prepared for the Covid pandemic.

Exercise Cygnet in Wales (2015) and Cygnus in England (2016) warned that a serious epidemic could find our NHS and privatised elderly care service without enough PPE, medical ventilators and critical and intensive care beds.

British and Welsh governments largely ignored the findings and failed to carry out the investment needed.

Policies to favour the City of London banks and markets have allowed our manufacturing base to stagnate — so governments, health authorities and care homes had to turn to China and other countries for vital protective and medical equipment.

Early last year, the disastrous responses of the London Tory government to the Covid outbreak made matters worse. Desperate to protect business profits, it failed to order full lock-downs early enough and ended them too soon.

The giant drug companies had to be bribed to produce testing kits and anti-virals. The privatised 'test and trace' system was an expensive disaster until the NHS took it over.

Had Britain not left the EU, we might have been trapped in the vaccine power-grab by the European Commission which has already cost many thousands of lives on the Continent.

Instead, thanks to the NHS and its GPs, and to our universities, local authorities and volunteers, we now have one of the most successful vaccination programmes in the world.

But now we face the return of mass unemployment. After bailing out business with the biggest rescue plan since the 2008 financial crash, the Tory government intends to make the rest of us pay. Taxes will go up, public sector workers face more real wage cuts and our services will suffer.

The Welsh government will have its block grant squeezed as never before.

For these and other reasons, Welsh Communists demand 'Real power for the people of Wales'.

In this manifesto, we spell out why the people of Wales, the Senedd and the Welsh government need:

- **Economic and environmental powers** for a modern, sustainable economy
- **Financial powers** to invest in jobs, industry and public services
- **Power at work** to win fair pay, conditions and pensions
- **Power in the community** to protect families, friends and neighbours
- **Power for Wales** with equal status in a federal Britain

ECONOMIC AND ENVIRONMENTAL POWERS

UNEMPLOYMENT FIGHTBACK!

In Wales, we know as much as anyone how mass unemployment devastates lives and local communities. It produces anxiety and fear, economic distress, family disruption, debt, poverty, malnutrition and homelessness. People are demoralised as they lose their confidence and dignity. Trust and solidarity between workmates is eroded as pay and working conditions are undermined.

Unemployment is not caused by lazy or greedy workers, strikers, 'benefit scroungers', immigrants 'taking our jobs' or workers who lack skills. Those are the people targeted by the right-wing press and politicians, who want to sow division when we need unity.

We now face a surge in unemployment in the wake of the Covid crisis. But this is not the root of the problem.

From time to time, workers have always been thrown out of work in large numbers. It happened before Covid-19 and will again afterwards.

Capitalism is a system in which the drive for profits produced booms, gluts and slumps. On top of this, whole industries and regions can go into decline.

Domination of our economy by the City of London bankers and speculators makes our economy even more unbalanced and unstable.

Tory governments try to ensure that working people and their families pay for the crisis with their jobs and livelihoods. Then, as rival companies go under and labour becomes cheaper, the big corporations find it profitable again to revive employment, investment and production.

OUR STRATEGIC AIMS

Only an economic system — socialism — based on democratic planning, public ownership of strategic industries, investment in modern and sustainable technology, first-class public services and full employment will put an end to the destructive crises of capitalism.

In the meantime, what we need in Wales and Britain are governments and policies that will:

- Protect jobs in vital industries and services as a top priority.
- Outlaw asset-stripping, mass redundancies and company 'fire and re-hire' schemes.
- Take failing companies into democratic public ownership.
- Promote new technologies that maintain wages, reduce hours and enhance working conditions.
- Plan the economy to ensure that we have balanced, sustainable development that will lift people's living standards everywhere.

PUBLIC OWNERSHIP AND INVESTMENT

Relying on big business, foreign investors and venture capital 'entrepreneurs' will never create a secure and stable basis for the economy.

They come to Wales, take public money to set up or expand their operations, then they cut and run ... or hold out a bigger begging bowl. This often sends smaller contractors to the wall when what they need is a secure place in the supply chain.

The Welsh Communist Party has long argued that public money should be matched by a public shareholding in the company. This could mean nationalisation of important enterprises where the alternative is bankruptcy and mass redundancies.

When large numbers of jobs are under threat in a strategically important industry, for example at Airbus in Broughton or Liberty Steel in Llanwern, direct state intervention must involve not only financial support but a stake in the company that gives a powerful voice to central and local government.

In particular, we call for the establishment of a Welsh National Economic Development Authority with the power and resources not only to invest in new or failing enterprises, but also to direct the investment of private capital to where it is needed most. Welsh Communists have long called for a comprehensive Economic Plan for Wales, but we also must have the powers and resources to implement one.

Local government and community organisations should also have the powers and resources to set up new enterprises in their areas, especially in order to promote community energy and transport schemes, 'green' technology and home improvement projects, and the like. Many such ventures could be run along cooperative lines, involving workers and communities in decision-making.

POLICIES FOR THE PLANET

Today's climate emergency has arisen as a result of the wasteful practices and overproduction of the capitalist system. In Wales we have seen centuries of exploitation of our natural resources to benefit big business, often based outside our country, and this has contributed greatly to the current crisis. Our coal reserves were ruthlessly exploited, our land has been mismanaged and our water resources plundered.

The Welsh Communist Party calls for substantial investment in renewable energy production, an increase in public transport and rail haulage, and a new approach to land use and agriculture.

We appreciate that the proposed Severn Barrage cannot be supported because of its detrimental local environmental impacts, but schemes to develop tidal lagoon power in Swansea Bay and the Severn estuary offer greater benefit and lower impact. There is also an urgent need to investigate the possibilities for harnessing tidal power in the Dee and Clwyd estuaries. There is scope to expand offshore wind farms around Wales.

The aim should be to shift completely to renewable sources. In the transition period we support the development of clean coal with carbon capture technology from deep mining, with no open-casting. This offers a much safer option as a transition fuel than nuclear fission. We support those struggling for a nuclear-free Wales until it can be demonstrated that a safe nuclear fusion option is available.

Under EU systems, our agriculture has been designed for export to the EU market, whilst exposing our retail sector to massive imports. The environmental consequences of importing large quantities of lamb from New Zealand while we export 95% of Welsh lamb is only one example of the chaos of the current market system.

A focus on local needs will free up a proportion of Welsh agricultural land for alternative uses such as natural carbon capture and storage through replacement of trees and the reinstatement of natural bog-lands.

We recognise that the carbon trading schemes developed by the EU and the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change are yet another attempt to shift the burden of the climate crisis away from the big business producers and their government backers who are most responsible. We need direct regulation of industry and funding for carbon reduction from direct taxation, instead of allowing the big polluters to continue to wreck the planet.

FINANCIAL POWERS

The Welsh Parliament needs the powers to raise funds and invest in local and regional economies. Too many of our communities have suffered decades of neglect. This cannot continue.

The Senedd and local authorities must have greater freedom from central government and Whitehall to raise funds from the low-interest Public Works Loan Board and in the capital markets.

The Council Tax should be replaced by a local income tax based on the ability to pay. This will end the unfairness inflicted on low-income households.

As a result of Brexit, EU rules limiting the right of devolved and local government to award public procurement contracts locally no longer apply. That new power must be fully devolved to the Senedd, so that preference can be given to supporting jobs and businesses in our local communities.

Leaving the EU also enables the Bank of England to extend credit and bond purchase facilities to devolved and local government and other public bodies, which should be made full use of when the terms are more favourable than in the 'free' market.

The Barnett block grant formula does not recognise the needs of deprived working-class communities when allocating funds central funds to Wales and our local public services. It must be replaced by arrangements that do not disadvantage Wales.

In addition, the Senedd must have its own taxation powers to end the near-total reliance on central governments in London. These should include the right to retain a share of PAYE revenues generated in Wales, to raise the top rates of income tax and to introduce its own taxes and levies on wealth, development land and 'luxury' projects.

The benefits system is a vital lifeline for many. It's not implemented fairly in Wales, where we have a higher incidence of sickness and incapacity benefits. Our own government should have the ability to supplement particular benefits where funding allows and the ensure that they are administered humanely.

In current circumstances, for example, the Welsh parliament and government should have the power and resources to consolidate the £20 weekly uplift into the basic level of Universal Credit. At present, it is due to be withdrawn in October, tipping tens of thousands of Welsh families deeper into poverty.

FUNDING LONG-TERM CARE

The Welsh government recognised the challenge of planning for long-term care when commissioning the Holtham Report, Paying for Care. But there are significant gaps in the Report's findings.

Holtham's proposal for a ring-fenced social care portion of income tax ignores the potential that a tax on wealth and profits could have.

As Communists, we believe that accumulated private and corporate wealth as

well as big business profits should play their part in funding social care. In Wales as elsewhere, that burden should not rest only or mainly on individual income tax payers.

For Britain as a whole, the Communist Party proposes to make the rich and big business pay for their bail-outs with a Wealth Tax; a windfall tax on the banking and other super-profits; an increase in top rates of Capital Gains Tax; and an immediate increase in Corporation Tax for large enterprises.

POWER AT WORK

True democracy extends beyond the ballot box and concerns the power that working people desire over their everyday lives.

The positive measures in the Trade Union (Wales) Act 2017 show how the Senedd can legislate to improve the rights of workers.

But we still don't have the power in Wales to extend those rights and ensure a better deal for people at work. Every employee must have the right in their trade union to take part in decision-making on wage and pensions issues; terms and conditions of employment; employment restructuring; and major investment decisions.

More effective legislation should be introduced to stamp out the organised exclusion of trade unionists from employment. It should be lawful for all workers to take collective solidarity action without fear of victimisation and the sack.

In particular, the Senedd should have the power to stop the scourge of low pay.

In Wales, we generally experience lower wage levels than in Britain as a whole — they are even more unequal for women workers — and have a high proportion of employees in part-time and short-term jobs.

Yet, as the Low pay Commission has confirmed, the current regime for enforcing the National Minimum Wage Act is inadequate, especially in particular sectors and for apprentices.

The Welsh government should be given the powers and resources not only to enforce the statutory minimum wage in Wales, but also the option to increase it. This would end the law's pay discrimination against young workers.

Where Britain-wide collective bargaining is in place and working well, this should be supported — but the power to legislate on these issues must reside in Wales.

POWER IN THE COMMUNITY

CLEANER, SAFER, CONNECTED COMMUNITIES

We need to make sure that people can travel for work within or near their local community, comfortably and affordably. That will reduce and combat carbon emissions and help our communities to survive and thrive.

The need to end the routine whereby large numbers of commuters crowd the M4, the A55, the A48 and the A470 every morning and evening must be brought to an end. It is wasteful and unsustainable. The long commute by private car must be consigned to the history books, replaced by efficient public transport.

The Covid emergency has shown that many service jobs can be carried out from home for much of the time. We need schemes funded by the public and private sectors to make this happen, supported by the roll-out of superfast broadband to all our local communities.

Together with the transport unions, the Communist Party believes that the railways and bus services should be brought back into public ownership, where they can be properly planned, coordinated and funded.

A decade of austerity cuts must be reversed. Street lighting should be restored and extended to make our communities safer. Local police stations must open their doors to the public again. More wardens, park attendants and transport staff would make more of our open spaces safe for the public.

No locality in Wales should be without advice, support and safe accommodation nearby for women and children seeking to escape domestic violence. Can there be a more urgent and necessary priority for action by the Welsh and local government, working in partnership with voluntary sector agencies?

HEALTH

We have all applauded the heroic work done by our health workers throughout the crisis. But the current crisis has also highlighted our reliance on precarious supply chains for medicines, equipment and personal protective equipment (PPE).

We cannot rely on multinational corporations to produce the hospital and protective equipment, the medicines, the test-and-trace systems and the vaccines that will be so desperately needed to overcome future epidemics.

The private companies' overriding priority is the profits of a few, not the health of the many. The big pharmaceutical companies have grown fat on public money and the NHS for long enough – they should be taken into public ownership and made to serve the public good.

It is essential that Wales continues its divergent path from the British

government when it comes to the involvement of the private sector in the health service. The Welsh government has helped retain the public spirit ethos of Aneurin Bevan's original vision, but our NHS remains vulnerable to greedy elements which prey on it. We need an urgent review of those areas of the Welsh NHS exploited by private firms.

We also face an immediate funding crisis in the NHS in Wales. But we cannot rely only on ever increasing hospital budgets, new drugs and equipment. We must shift to a much greater emphasis on social and environmental determinants of ill-health and to prevention.

PREVENTION IS BETTER THAN CURE

To tackle health inequalities, we need a system that brings together communities, their GPs and the full range of public services to act on the causes of ill-health. Since the 1970s the World Health Organisation has recognised the importance of community involvement in prevention and public health policies. Government reports repeat this, yet it is not successfully embedded in Wales.

The way GP surgeries are commissioned and run needs to change. In each area, we need a primary health service that has responsibility for that whole community's long-term health. The chief causes of ill-health in each community must be locally assessed and targeted, whether they are poor housing, poor diet, or a lack of open spaces and free or affordable exercise facilities.

Primary health partnerships should bring together GPs, the local council and residents, housing associations, schools and public health professionals to tackle generations of ill-health.

In many areas, securing an appointment with a GP or dentist is far too difficult even in normal conditions, while in other areas GPs compete for patients. At the all-Wales level, therefore, there needs to be a planned approach to the training and recruitment of medical staff based on projected need in every locality.

A NATIONAL CARE SERVICE

The Covid-19 pandemic has demonstrated both the fragility of our care service and the dedication of its staff.

The direct delivery of personal social care must be entrusted only to well-trained, decently paid professionals. We need to tackle the poor pay and conditions in the sector and the staff shortages and under-funding which plague it.

That's why trade unions and the Communist Party demand a standard employment contract for care work – including sick pay, contracted hours and pay for all hours on duty, including 'sleep-ins' and travel time – applying to workers in clients' own homes and in residential homes.

The wholesale privatisation of elderly care has led to 'free market' anarchy and chaos. A lot of private companies compete for contracts from local authorities, triggering a 'race to the bottom' in the quality of training, pay and care. In

wealthier areas, many firms compete for the custom; in other areas, care providers are scarce.

Welsh Communists call for much greater integration between health and care services. Currently, the complexity of funding is a nightmare for workers, residents and their families. Funding is allocated from separate budgets for an individual's social care and basic or complex nursing needs.

The complex web of local authority, NHS and private funding adds inconsistency, delay and huge bureaucratic burdens. Residential and nursing care should be free at the point of need and planned over the long-term.

We owe it to our ageing population to plan the provision of sheltered housing, care home places and properly trained and rewarded staffing over a 25-year period. At the core must be publicly owned and accountable public sector provision; privately-owned care homes would have to help deliver the plan and its high standards or face closure.

A CHARTER FOR HOUSING

A good-quality, affordable and secure home is a basic human right.

The CP campaigns for a new approach to housing to meet the needs and aspirations of the people; not to feed the greed of landowners, developers, bankers and big shareholders.

The priorities must be to eradicate sub-standard housing, overcrowding, unfair rents and homelessness.

Around 8,000 new homes are required in Wales each year simply to meet growing demand. That's 2,000 more than the annual new-build. Then there are the 67,000 households on waiting lists.

Meanwhile there are almost 30,000 residential properties in Wales — almost all in the private sector — which have been empty for more than six months.

The Communist Party has just published a Charter for Housing which puts forward the policies to achieve these aims. These include:

- Building much more council and social housing — more than 10,000 units a year in Wales.
- Regenerating run-down council estates.
- Ending sales of public land to private developers.
- Using more Compulsory Purchase Orders (CPOs) where necessary.
- Taxing owners of vacant land and properties more steeply.
- Establishing national and local savings institutions that specialise in housing finance and support national and local housing strategies.

Such a programme could be further funded from a Land Development Tax on windfall profits and by lifting the limits placed on capital borrowing by local authorities and housing associations, allowing them greater access to low-interest credits and loans from the Bank of England and National Public Works Loan Board.

All social housing should be brought back under direct and accountable local authority control, with adequate funding and the re-establishment of direct labour organisations.

Free or affordable sheltered accommodation and residential care must be available for the elderly in every part of Wales.

The provision of suitable accommodation for all homeless households should be a real statutory duty, in order to end overcrowding and rough sleeping. The Bedroom Tax should be repealed and full housing benefit restored for all under 35s.

Private sector rent rises and levels should be capped in keeping with local circumstances and subject to a national limit. In response to Covid, we call for a freeze on social housing rents and extending the Coronavirus ban on evictions for at least 12 months.

The Communist Party supports organisations at local, regional and national level that campaign for improved tenants' rights and for housing development to be locally-controlled and based on assessed housing need.

EDUCATION

The Communist Party applauds the work done by education trade unionists to keep our children safe during the pandemic. School staff, in consultation with parents, pupils and the wider community, have shown leadership and compassion through the Covid crisis. They should lead the much-needed reforms in our schools and colleges.

We need an alternative assessment system to replace the madness of the 'exam factory'. Frontline education professionals need to be freed from the bureaucracy of Estyn (the Welsh equivalent of Ofsted) and layers of regional management.

Only then can we design a future that values and enhances our children's talents, rather than one designed for the production of league tables.

Education plays a vital role in supporting the Welsh language. Welsh-medium schools and nurseries must become readily available in every part of Wales. This is no small task and new measures are required to support the increasing use of Welsh in every school environment and for training many more bilingual teachers.

Fee-paying schools are a system of class discrimination that entrenches social inequality and privilege. They have no place in a democratic society. Communists advocate the abolition of private education in Wales.

POWER FOR PARENTS AND CARERS

Jobs that do not make a profit – such as caring for family members — are not valued as they should be in our society. As the pandemic has shown, this is also true of essential workers in the public and private sectors.

We should not be surprised: capitalism is a system organised to make profit. Most of that profit belongs to the wealthiest top layer of people. Most of it is not invested back into the community, funding vital industries and services. Much of it is spent on luxury products, or on financial and property speculation, or sent to British-run tax havens around the world. To those who have, more shall be given.

By forcing as many people as possible into waged work, capitalism erodes our bonds of family and community. Fewer people are left to care for our children, our elderly and our most vulnerable. Of those who do, many face poverty and a lack of support from a system that doesn't care much about the carers.

Overwhelmingly, it is women who bear the brunt of unpaid and low-paid care work in our society.

Depending on the circumstances, caring for others leaves many carers at an extra disadvantage when they reach retirement age. As well as missing out on an occupational or workplace pension, they may not qualify for the full state pension.

Caring for children, too, is undervalued and in many cases unpaid. Entitlements to child-related tax credits and benefits have been slashed.

Yet 180,000 children in Wales live in poverty. That is more than one in four (28%) and rising due to Tory welfare reforms and the impact of Covid on jobs and incomes. Worse is coming unless we stop it.

That's why Welsh Communists propose these measures as part of a programme across Britain to support parents, children and carers and abolish child poverty:

- A Social Wage for all parents and carers who leave waged work in order to care for children, family or community members.
- The full state pension for all parents and carers who have taken time away from waged work to care for their children, family or community members.
- More extensive paid maternity and paternity leave for all parents: keep jobs open to parents until all their children are of statutory school age.
- Free childcare from birth for those parents who wish to return to waged work after childbirth.
- Paid Parental Leave from work for child-related emergencies.
- A generously funded and robust National Care Service which would offer services for care in much the same way as a generously funded and robust NHS can offer services for health.

A REAL VOICE FOR YOUNG PEOPLE

Communists welcome the votes and the voice of young people in this election. These Senedd elections will be the first in which 16- and 17-year-olds (and legally resident foreign nationals) are allowed to vote in Wales, and some 65,000 citizens under 18 are expected to benefit.

Votes at 16 has been the policy of the Communist Party since the early 1990s.

Young workers and students face growing challenges and they deserve the right to participate in elections more fully. They have already been hit hard by Covid-19. We are living through an epidemic in mental health problems among young people.

The unemployment rate for 18-24 year-olds has more than doubled since March 2020 to 14% — one in seven young people. Almost half of young women workers in Wales, and more than a quarter of young men, are in the 'shut down' sectors. Scores of thousands could lose their jobs when the 'furlough' subsidy runs out in October.

Many others face the prospect of low-paid, precarious and unfulfilling work, poverty pay, inadequate apprenticeships or a dead-end job in the gig economy.

College and university students also have to work long hours to support themselves. Tuition fees have made debt the first adult experience of their lives. This is shameful.

Even those who are in work or college struggle to find a home in their local community, near family or in areas they really want to live in. Home ownership for the younger generation is often a pipe-dream or a question of inheritance.

Violent crime and anti-social behaviour have been escalating across our society, with a disproportionate impact on young people themselves.

But we must not allow this to become the first generation in the modern era to live a worse life than those who have gone before. In the face of adversity, young people are right to fight for a brighter future.

That's why Communists call for free access to council-run leisure centres and facilities, with efforts to encourage regular use among all young people.

The reopening and expansion of youth centres will also be essential as we emerge from the Covid lockdowns, giving young people a friendly, open place to gather and socialise outside school or work.

The negative impact of austerity on library and leisure facilities and services also needs to be reversed, with special grants available to ensure adequate access for our disabled fellow citizens. In rural and inner city areas, councils should establish internet and digital service hubs opening up free access to people without wifi.

Of course, this will only be made possible by an emergency and longer-term injection of funds into the youth and community services devastated by a decade

of short-sighted public spending cuts.

The Young Communist League is the fastest growing political youth organisation in Britain. Celebrating its 100th anniversary, the YCL has begun its biggest campaign in decades to win support for its Youth Charter (<https://ycl.org.uk/youth-charter/>).

- The aims of the Charter include:
- A real living wage with an end to casualisation and age discrimination in pay.
- A new apprenticeship system and real jobs with union and employment rights.
- More council housing and tighter private sector rent controls.
- Public transport network cards for young people with capped, affordable prices.
- Free college and university education.
- Free access to government and council cultural, leisure and sports facilities.
- Free access to all NHS Healthcare and improved mental and sexual health services.

Young people are the future. They can make a better Wales and a better world. They can rely on the Welsh Communists for support and solidarity.

POWER FOR WALES

Brexit means we have new opportunities despite the determination of LibDems and Greens (and many in Welsh Labour) to defend discredited EU policies and reverse Brexit. This means these new opportunities are not being fought for.

As a direct result of Brexit, at least 70 new decision-making powers are due to come to the Senedd directly from Brussels. They cover such important areas as transport, energy, water resources, agriculture, the environment, climate change, public procurement contracts, equal rights at work, biodiversity, animal welfare, waste management, food regulation, medical standards and elections.

These powers are spelt out in the Revised Framework Analysis (2019) published by the Cabinet Office.

But instead of informing the people of Wales about them, or fighting for them to come to Wales in full, and working out how they can be used to benefit the people of Wales, most parties in the Senedd have spent the past five years campaigning for them to remain in Brussels!

Welsh Labour, Plaid Cymru, the LibDems and the Greens have all tried to block and overturn the democratic result of the 2016 EU referendum, when the people of Wales and Britain voted to leave the capitalist big business EU.

Taking advantage of this obstruction and chaos, the Tories won the 2019 General Election, took us out of the EU ... and then misused Brexit to steal economic and industrial powers stolen from the Senedd under the 2002 Single Market Act.

Only the Welsh Communist Party insists that all these powers belong in Wales, with our own elected representatives.

PROGRESSIVE FEDERALISM

Now that we have left the EU, the opportunity exists to create a progressive federal Britain based on self-government, equality and solidarity between its three nations.

That is the only realistic alternative to unionism — which maintains the domination of Welsh politics and economics by a largely English ruling class — and to 'separatism', which denies the close economic and social relations between Wales and England and between our labour and progressive movements.

Plaid Cymru's version of 'independence' would give away the powers we desperately need in Wales to the unelected EU Commission, the unaccountable European Central Bank and the anti-trade union EU Court of Justice. The Treasury in London would run our currency.

At the same time, political separation from Britain would allow the super-rich concentrated around the City of London and south-east England to keep the enormous wealth created by the workers of Wales, England and Scotland.

Instead, Welsh Communists call for a Wealth Tax that would redistribute it to the peoples of every nation and region in Britain.

The Communist Party has called for Welsh self-government in a federal Britain for more than 70 years. The policy is now gaining support in some Welsh Labour circles.

We want to see working people and their allies exercising increasing control over the capitalist monopolies and the allocation of economic and financial resources at federal, national and regional level.

More than anything else, the Covid emergency has shown how much we depend on working people for everything — for our health, our safety, our food, our energy supplies and our transport system.

In a society driven by company profits, the greed of big shareholders trumps the needs of working people and their families.

That's why the communists say:

The crisis is Capitalism — the solution is Socialism.

Vote Communist.
Vote for your community.
Vote for the common
good.

